

BA FASHION DESIGN

Module	5FADE002W/1 - SURFACE
Module Leader	Priya Raman / Tomas Egger
Key Dates/Times	Briefing: Monday 21 September 2026, 10:30 Print studio induction: Wednesday 23 September 2026 (mandatory) Dye lab induction: Thursday 24 September 2026 (mandatory) Interim review: Monday 12 October 2026 Group presentation: Monday 19 October 2026 Hand in: Tuesday 27 October 2026 1pm Weeks of study: 6

Brief:

This module extends your knowledge and expertise of fabrication, embellishment, embroidery, fabric printing and dyeing techniques, in order to further the production of innovative and directional fashion design.

You will research an area of personal interest and develop individual design concepts within the context of a broad design brief, with the emphasis on textiles, surface decoration and print. The brief is deliberately wide: you define your own conceptual basis within the design process. What is assessed is not the subject you choose but the rigour with which you interrogate it and translate it into cloth.

This research becomes the basis of design development, producing a variety of design outcomes. 3D prototypes are produced both digitally and physically. Finally, a range of illustrations and portfolio work based on your design work and prototype is produced.

Personal Direction

Unlike Construction, this module does not prescribe a garment type. You must arrive at and defend your own territory. By the interim review on 12 October you are expected to have:

- A defined area of personal interest, stated in a single paragraph
- Primary research that is genuinely yours - drawn, photographed or collected first-hand, not sourced online
- An argued position on why this material warrants translation into textile
- At least three technique routes tested, not one pursued and two named

A concept that cannot survive being described in one sentence is not yet a concept.

Technique Requirements

You must develop work across a minimum of THREE of the following, and at least one must be a wet process:

- Screen or digital print (placement, repeat, or engineered)
- Dyeing: immersion, resist, discharge or over-dye (wet process)
- Embroidery: hand, machine or digitised
- Embellishment: applied, beaded, or constructed surface
- Fabrication: felting, bonding, quilting, pleating, laser or heat manipulation

Combining techniques on one cloth is encouraged where it is argued. Combination for its own sake reads as indecision.

Studio Access and Inductions

The print studio and dye lab both require induction before access. These are timetabled in week one and attendance is mandatory - you may not book either facility without them, and there is no repeat session. Plan your sampling around booked studio time rather than assuming availability.

- Print studio induction - Wednesday 23 September, A Building
- Dye lab induction - Thursday 24 September, A Building
- Both facilities are bookable in three-hour slots and are heavily used in weeks 3-5

Sustainability and Responsibility

Surface processes are among the most resource-intensive in the industry. Dyeing and finishing account for a significant share of textile water use and effluent. You are required to document and critically evaluate:

- Water use and disposal for any wet process you undertake
- The fibre content of your substrates and its implications for dye choice and longevity
- Whether your surface treatment shortens or extends the useful life of the cloth
- One lower-impact alternative to a process you used, tested rather than merely named

This module engages UN Sustainable Development Goals 6 (Clean Water and Sanitation) and 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production).

Research Requirements

Research must be evidenced through:

- Observational drawing and mark-making generated from primary sources
- Material collection and annotated swatch gathering
- Museum, gallery and archive visits - the Westminster Menswear Archive and the V&A; textile study rooms are both accessible to you
- Library and academic sources; online sources alone are not sufficient
- Fabric sourcing visits, with substrate samples and supplier notes recorded

Assessment:

Assessment name	Weighting %	Qualifying mark %	Assessment type
Portfolio	100%		Research, Design Development and Portfolio, Textile Samples, 3D and D

Work to be submitted for Assessment:

PDF document (approx 34 pages) plus physical sample folder and prototype. File name format:
Forename_Surname_Surface_2026_PDF

Part 1: Research and Design Development Portfolio (minimum 14 pages)

- Contextual and visual research into your chosen area of personal interest
- Primary drawing, mark-making and photographic study
- Colour direction with a resolved palette and its source
- Surface direction boards showing at least three technique routes under consideration
- Capsule collection: fully rendered line-up of 6 outfits, front and back views
- Black and white technical drawing of the final garment, front and back, on Illustrator

Part 2: Textile Development and Sampling (8 pages)

- Minimum 6 developed physical samples across at least three techniques, one of which is a wet process
- Documented process for each sample: substrate, method, parameters, outcome, evaluation
- Repeat or placement development for any printed work, with the working file
- Substrate testing: at least three fabrics tested against your chosen technique with recorded results
- Water, waste and energy notes for every wet process undertaken
- Costing sheet for the developed surface at sample and at production scale

Part 3: Prototype (6 pages)

- One garment or 3D outcome carrying your developed surface
- Photographed on a stand: front, back and side views
- Photographed on a model
- Detail photographs of the surface at close range, raking light where texture is the point

Part 4: Digital Development (6 pages)

- CLO3D visualisation of the final outcome with your surface applied as a texture
- Evidence of digital print or pattern development where relevant

- Snapshots from the 2D and 3D windows without the avatar
- Comparison and commentary between the digital and physical outcome

Physical Submission

- Sample folder, labelled, with each sample cross-referenced to its page in Part 2
- Prototype with name and group number stitched inside the back neck

Interim Review and Presentation

The interim review on 12 October is formative and not separately weighted, but attendance and preparation contribute to professional practice. Bring your concept statement, primary research and first samples pinned up.

The group presentation on 19 October is ten minutes plus questions. Present your direction, your technique decisions and what the sampling has told you - including what failed.